DO YOU KNOW?

Every 5th person in India is an adolescent – Hence adolescents are a very precious segment of the population.

Significant changes in the area of social development occur in the period of adolescence with regard to their peers and relationship with adults.

- **Relationship** with peers- Adolescents are very much influenced by their peer group. Their behaviour and attitude are affected by peers.
- **Relationship with adults**- Adolescents develop values different from the ones held by adults because the influence of peer group is more than that of adults. Hence the adolescent is torn between his loyalty to his parents and peers. Their values often clash with those of adults and many rebel against parental authority

Activity 4

Compare And Contrast Any Six Values Between Adults And Present Generation Adolescents

Values	Opinion of adults	Opinion of adolescents

(d) Emotional changes

Adolescence is said to be a period of heightened emotionality. Heightened emotionality is a state of more than normal emotional experience. This period is often known as the "period of storm and stress". The word storm and stress suggest anger and turmoil.



Causes for Heightened Emotionality

The major causes for heightened emotionality are as follows:

- **Psychological problems due to physical changes –** Sudden spurt in height, appearance of secondary sex characteristics, voice change, appearance of pimples and acne, on the face. etc. cause much embarrassment to them and they become worried about their physical appearances.
- **Social expectations-** Adolescents are treated neither as a child nor as an adult. The constant pressure to live up to social expectations causes a generalized state of anxiety in them.
- **Unrealistic aspirations-** Adolescent aspirations are sometimes unrealistic. When they are not able to attain them they feel inferior and frustrated.
- **Urge for sex-** Reproductive hormones are active and so there is the presence of sex urge. This may lead to anxiety.
- **Identity crises-** The adolescent is expected to form a realistic self-concept. They have to try out different roles and develop a holistic idea of their future role. Until they find their role they are often confused and anxious

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